



“Fueling Global Trade, Connecting Continents”

DDS MARINE WEEKLY

MARITIME INTELLIGENCE

TANKERS | ENERGY | STS | COMPLIANCE

Insight. Safety. Excellence.

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Executive Market Dashboard

Market snapshot: data cut-off **Friday 2 October 2026** | Ship & Bunker, Integr8 Fuels, Bunker Index, oilprice.com, Trading Economics, wire reporting and DDS Marine market intelligence

BRENT CRUDE

US\$102.3–102.7/bbl

▼ Friday, two public sources; dipped to 98.43 on G7 release news

WTI CRUDE

US\$91.1–91.3/bbl

▼ one-month low of 88.06 intraday Friday; Integr8 settle 95.69 (Thu)

SINGAPORE VLSFO

US\$770.5–825/mt

▼ S&B index 789.00, down from 874.00 in Issue 009

FUJAIRAH VLSFO

US\$947.5–1,241/mt

▲ three sources disagree; two of three cluster at US\$948–980

MIDDLE EAST OIL EXPORTS

12.8m bpd

▲ September, highest since the war began (Kpler); pre-war ~17m

HORMUZ TANKER STRIKES

3 TANKERS HIT

▼ 29–30 Sep; all crew safe; at least two were transiting dark

DDS VIEW — *The Gulf is shipping more oil than at any point since the war began, and the risk of shipping it has not fallen. Middle East exports reached about 12.8 million barrels a day in September, Yanbu loadings resumed, and Indian refiners have started chartering ships to lift Gulf crude through Hormuz themselves. In the same week three tankers were struck in the Strait, the US ordered a third aircraft carrier towards Iran, and China halted most October fuel exports. G7 governments responded to the diesel shortage with a 100-million-barrel reserve release, which briefly pushed Brent below US\$100. For our corridor the message is: **volumes are coming back faster than safety is, and the diesel shortage is now a global problem, not only a Gulf one.***

This Week at a Glance

- **Exports recover, attacks continue:** Gulf oil exports about 12.8m bpd in September (Kpler), while three Liberia-flagged tankers were struck in Hormuz on 29–30 Sep.
- **Yanbu back in business:** loadings resumed late in the week of 22 Sep; pipeline throughput is reported at 2–2.65m bpd, against a 7m bpd capacity.
- **Diesel becomes the crisis:** China halted most October fuel exports, Russia extended its diesel export ban to 31 Oct, and the G7 agreed to release up to 100m barrels.
- **US military build-up:** a third carrier group and 9,000–10,000 more troops ordered to the region; Patriot batteries sent to protect Saudi and Qatari energy sites.
- **Bunker sources diverge:** Fujairah VLSFO quoted from US\$947.50 to US\$1,241 across three sources; Singapore eased to US\$789 on Ship & Bunker's index.



CEO Market Commentary

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC — Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

“When every gauge reads maximum, read the gauges more carefully.”

Two weeks ago the bypass failed. Last week it came back. This week the Gulf exported more oil than at any time since the war began — about 12.8 million barrels a day in September, according to Kpler — and Yanbu is loading again. If you only read the volume numbers, you would think the worst was over.

It is not. On 29 and 30 September three tankers were struck in the Strait of Hormuz. Washington is sending a third aircraft carrier and up to 10,000 more troops, and has moved Patriot batteries to protect Saudi and Qatari energy facilities. Iran’s foreign minister says his country is “fully prepared” to resume the conflict. Oil is moving because buyers need it badly enough to accept the risk, not because the risk has gone. Indian refiners have even begun hiring ships to bring Gulf crude through Hormuz themselves.

The bigger story this week is diesel. China has stopped most of its October fuel exports. Russia has extended its diesel ban to the end of the month. The G7 has agreed to release up to 100 million barrels, half of it diesel. That is a crisis response, and it tells you where the real shortage is. It is also why every tanker segment on our DDS scale now sits at the top. For the first time in this series, we score every segment Exceptionally Firm.

I want to be careful with that result. When every reading is at maximum, the scale stops telling you which market is strongest, and the risk becomes the fall. We will watch closely for the first segment to come off the top.

I would apply the same caution to prices. This week our three bunker sources gave Fujairah VLSFO anywhere from about US\$948 to US\$1,241. Two of them agree; one does not. We do not choose quietly between them. The next page explains how we handled it.

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC

Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

Publication Principle — Independent operational commentary based on publicly available information, official releases and wire reporting carried by named outlets (Reuters, Bloomberg, Al Jazeera, Axios, oilprice.com, Seatrade Maritime), plus DDS Marine’s own market intelligence. Every figure in this issue carries its source and, where applicable, a stated data cut-off.



This Week in Review

The week's principal developments, 26 September – 2 October 2026

28–30 SEPTEMBER · REUTERS / KPLER (VIA OILPRICE.COM)

Middle East oil exports reach their highest since the war began

Gulf oil exports averaged about 12.8m bpd in September, against roughly 17m bpd before the war, with Saudi Arabia at about 5.4m bpd. Kpler put Hormuz flows at about 77% of pre-war levels. LNG lagged: about 21 cargoes passed through Hormuz in September, against more than 90 a month before the war, and Qatar has extended force majeure through November.

29–30 SEPTEMBER · SEATRADE / MARINELINK / TANKERTRACKERS

Yanbu loadings resume after the pipeline restart

Loadings at Yanbu restarted late in the week of 22 September. Satellite imagery showed nearly 10m barrels being loaded at Yanbu and Al Muajjiz on 27 September. Pipeline throughput is reported at 2–2.65m bpd, against a 7m bpd capacity, and full recovery could take another month. A VLCC fixture from the Red Sea to South Korea was reported this week (see Crude Tanker Market).

29–30 SEPTEMBER · UKMTO / MARISKS / REUTERS / WINDWARD

Three tankers struck in the Strait of Hormuz

Al Ruwais and *Mersin Prosperity*, both managed by ADNOC Logistics & Services, and the Aframax *Sinbad*, managed by Anglo-Eastern, were hit by unknown projectiles. All three are Liberia-flagged. One fire was extinguished and all crew are safe. Windward reports that at least two were transiting with AIS switched off.

1–2 OCTOBER · OILPRICE.COM / BLOOMBERG / NBC / THE NATIONAL

Diesel crisis: China halts exports, G7 releases reserves

China's major refiners suspended most October fuel exports to protect domestic supply; Kpler estimates China's diesel stocks are about 20m barrels below pre-war levels. Russia extended its producers' diesel and marine fuel export ban to 31 October. On 2 October the G7 agreed to release up to 100m barrels over four months — 50m of diesel from Europe and 50m of crude through the IEA.

1–2 OCTOBER · AL JAZEERA / BLOOMBERG / AXIOS / US TREASURY

US builds up forces and widens sanctions

A third carrier group and 9,000–10,000 more sailors and Marines have been ordered towards Iran, and two more Patriot batteries were sent to protect Saudi and Qatari energy sites. Washington rejected Iran's seven-day roadmap to reopen Hormuz and sanctioned Iran's automotive, rail and metals sectors on 1 October. Indirect talks continue without a breakthrough.



Data Integrity & Methodology

How this week's numbers were sourced, and how we handled disagreement between sources

This week each of our bunker sources produced one figure that the others do not support. We set out what we found and what we did about it, rather than choosing between sources without saying so.

Rule	How It Was Applied in Issue 010
1. Stated cut-off	Data cut-off Friday 2 October 2026 . Integr8 and Bunker Index are dated 2 October. Ship & Bunker's page did not show an assessment date for its latest posted prices, so we treat them as the latest available at our cut-off.
2. Ranges, not points	Bunker prices are shown as High–Low ranges with the index close alongside. Crude is shown as a Friday band across two public sources.
3. Dual-source cross-check	Run, and extended to three sources for Fujairah. Integr8's Friday indications were compared with Ship & Bunker; Bunker Index was added where the first two disagreed.
4. Contract month	Brent's front month rolled from November to December at the end of September. WTI remains on the November contract.

Where the Sources Disagree

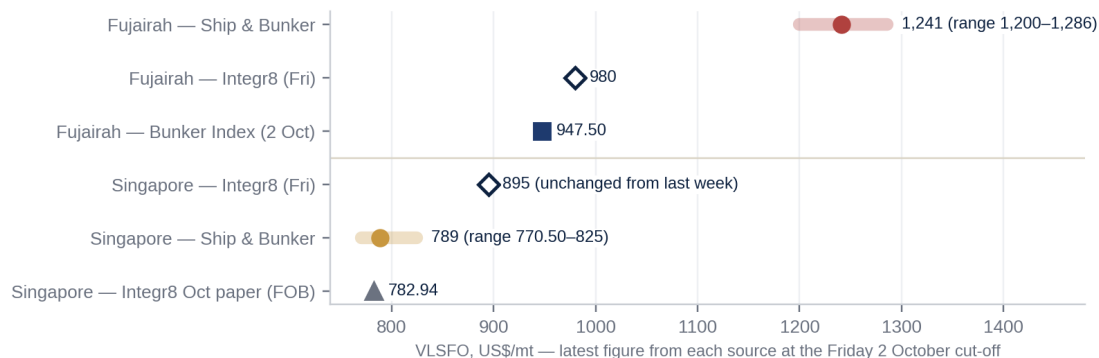


Figure	What We Found	How We Report It
Fujairah VLSFO	Ship & Bunker US\$1,241 (+58 on the day). Integr8 US\$980 and Bunker Index US\$947.50 are within US\$33 of each other.	Range US\$947.50–1,241; two of three sources cluster at US\$948–980.
Singapore VLSFO	Integr8's US\$895 is unchanged from last week, and Integr8's own Singapore paper fell to US\$782.94. Ship & Bunker's US\$789 is consistent with that paper price.	We use Ship & Bunker for Singapore this week and flag Integr8's figure as possibly not updated.
Fujairah premium	Ship & Bunker alone gives about US\$452; Integr8 alone gives US\$85. Neither is supported by a second source.	US\$158–191, using the two corroborated Fujairah figures against Ship & Bunker Singapore.

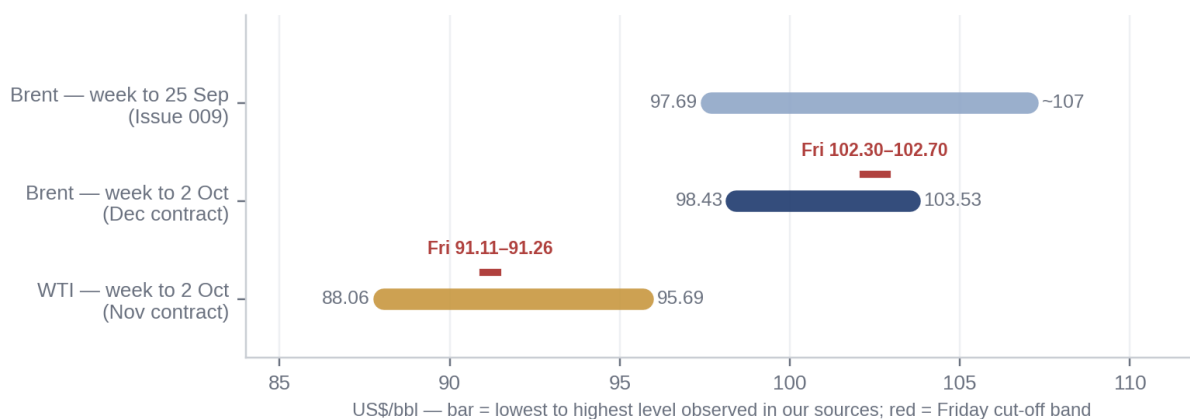
Correction & clarification: *Issue 009 dated the East-West pipeline shutdown 13 September (The National). Reports this week date the attack to 11 September (Seatrade, MarineLink) or 10 September (Integr8). The shutdown and the attack may fall on different days; we will use the Reuters-based date of 11 September for the attack from now on. Iran's vessel blacklist, reported as 77–78 in Issue 009, now stands at 81 (Seatrade, 28 September).*



Global Oil Market

Friday bands across two public sources; contract month disclosed; cut-off Friday 2 October 2026

Indicator	Friday 2 Oct (cut-off)	Week range	Reading
Brent crude	US\$102.30–102.70/bbl oilprice.com / Trading Economics; Integr8 settle 103.53 (1 Oct)	US\$98.43 (2 Oct, intraday) – US\$103.53 (1 Oct)	Weekly fall; dipped below US\$100 on the G7 release, recovered by the close.
WTI crude	US\$91.11–91.26/bbl November contract	US\$88.06 (2 Oct, intraday) – US\$95.69 (1 Oct)	Down about 2% on Friday after a one-month intraday low.
Murban	US\$110.80/bbl oilprice.com	—	Gulf-origin premium over Brent narrowed to about US\$8, from about US\$12.



Brent and WTI weekly ranges, week to 2 October, against Brent's range in the week covered by Issue 009. Sources: oilprice.com, Trading Economics, Flux, Integr8 settles.

Market Interpretation

Crude and diesel are now telling different stories. Crude supply is improving: Gulf exports are at their highest since the war began, and Kpler puts Hormuz flows at about 77% of pre-war levels. That, plus the G7 release, is why Brent ended the week lower despite the US military build-up and fresh tanker strikes.

Diesel is the tightest part of the barrel. China has halted most October fuel exports, Russia's ban runs to 31 October, and several Middle East and Russian refineries remain damaged. Before the G7 announcement, European diesel futures were above US\$200 a barrel and the diesel premium over crude was about US\$77; it narrowed to about US\$69 afterwards (oilprice.com). The release adds barrels but, as oilprice.com notes, "does not add refinery capacity." OPEC+ meets on 4 October and is expected to leave quotas unchanged.

DDS BASE CASE — Brent trades in a US\$95–108 band. Rising Gulf exports and the G7 release cap the upside; the US build-up and continuing tanker strikes support the floor. **Commercial effect on shipping:** diesel, not crude, is now driving product-tanker earnings and bunker costs. Budget gasoil-linked costs on a range, and expect further volatility.



Crude Tanker Market

VLCC, Suezmax and Aframax — DDS directional assessment, week ending 2 October 2026



DDS Freight Sentiment Index — DDS Marine's own analytical assessment. Not a third-party benchmark.

Segment	DDS Market Tone	Trend	Primary Driver
VLCC	5 / 5 — Exceptionally Firm	— At the top, steady	Oman STS shuttle and Yanbu restart both absorbing tonnage
Suezmax	5 / 5 — Exceptionally Firm	▲ ▲ Sharply higher	Atlantic demand surging as charterers avoid VLCC rates
Aframax	5 / 5 — Exceptionally Firm	▲ Firmer	Gulf–Asia and Atlantic strength; diesel-led refinery demand

Reported Fixture	Route	Terms	Source
DHT Gazelle (VLCC, 2026-built) — SK Energy	Red Sea (Yanbu) via Suez to South Korea, 270,000 t	US\$55m lump sum (~US\$634,000/day equivalent)	Tankers International, via Seatrade (30 Sep)

Market reported / subject to confirmation.

DDS Market Read

VLCC. Earnings stayed at the very top of the range, with two separate supports: the Saudi STS shuttle off Oman, where Seatrade estimates about 15% of VLCC capacity is waiting, and the restart of Yanbu, where satellite imagery showed about 40 tankers nearby. Houthi threats still keep VLCCs out of the southern Red Sea, so Yanbu cargoes bound for Asia are going via Suez, which lengthens voyages.

Suezmax and Aframax. Suezmax sentiment moved up sharply this week as Atlantic charterers continued to switch down from VLCCs. Indian refiners are now chartering third-party tankers to lift Gulf crude through Hormuz, which adds mid-size demand.

DDS VIEW — With all three crude segments at the top of our scale, the useful question is no longer which is strongest but which will ease first. Our view: VLCCs, if Hormuz traffic normalises and releases the Oman shuttle tonnage. Avoid long-term commitments priced on this week's earnings.

Source basis: Seatrade Maritime, MarineLink, Marine Insight, Kpler (via Reuters), and DDS Marine operational and commercial intelligence. Directional only.



Clean & Product Tankers

DDS Clean Tanker Signal and Pacific/Atlantic split — directional assessment, week ending 2 October 2026



DDS Freight Sentiment Index — DDS Marine's own analytical assessment. Not a third-party benchmark.

Market	DDS Score	Trend	DDS Assessment
LR ME Gulf – Europe / Japan	5 / 5	▲	Gulf-origin diesel and jet into short markets
MR ME Gulf – E Africa	5 / 5	▬ Steady	Regional disruption and short-haul Gulf demand
Intra-Asia / MR Pacific	5 / 5	▲	Asian diesel pull sharpened by China's export halt
Atlantic MR	5 / 5	▲ ▲ Up from 4/5	Western diesel shortage; Europe and US Gulf both short

Pacific / Atlantic: The Gap Has Closed

For the first time since we began tracking it in Issue 007, there is no gap between Pacific and Atlantic MR on our scale: both now score 5/5. Atlantic MR moved up as the diesel shortage spread to Europe and the US, where China's export halt and Russia's extended ban remove barrels the West had been importing. The G7 release will add diesel over four months, but tankers will be needed to move much of it.

DDS VIEW — *Intra-Asia clean employment remains the better risk-adjusted trade for our corridor because it avoids Gulf war-risk costs and STS queues. With Atlantic MR now equally firm, check positioning and ballast costs before switching basins.*

Source basis: public reporting (oilprice.com, Bloomberg, NBC, Kpler via Reuters) and DDS Marine operational and commercial intelligence. Directional only.

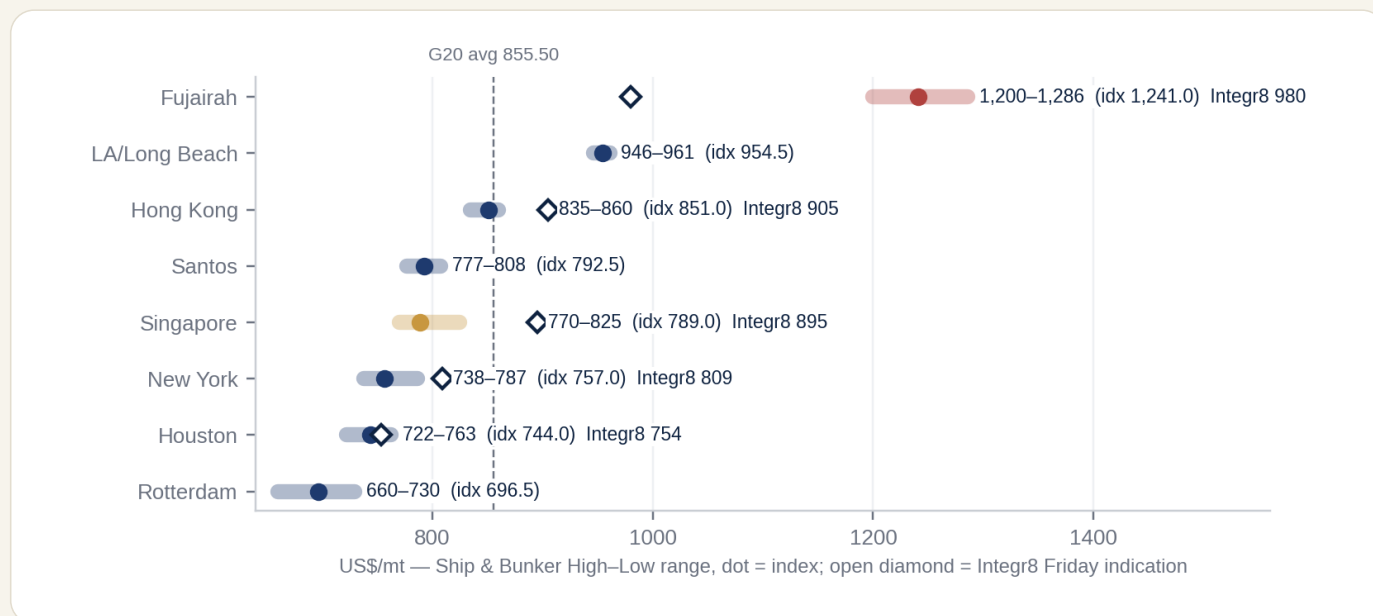


Bunker Market — Singapore & Global Benchmark

Ranges, not points — Ship & Bunker High/Low/index with Integr8 Friday 2 October indications

Grade / Hub	S&B Range	S&B Index	Day Change	Integr8 (Fri)	Issue 009
Singapore VLSFO	US\$770.50–825	US\$789.00	–US\$15.50	895*	874.00
Fujairah VLSFO	US\$1,200–1,286	US\$1,241.00	+US\$58.00	980	996.00
Singapore MGO	US\$1,082.50–1,185	US\$1,137.00	–US\$45.00	1,285*	1,325.00
Fujairah MGO	US\$1,528–1,570	US\$1,546.50	–US\$37.00	1,750	1,698.00
Singapore IFO380	US\$614.50–639.50	US\$630.00	–US\$21.00	765*	711.50
Fujairah IFO380	US\$612–643	US\$627.50	–US\$33.00	700	701.00

* Integr8 Singapore figures are unchanged or nearly unchanged from last week and well above Integr8's own Singapore paper; treated as possibly not updated (see Data Integrity).



VLSFO High–Low range by hub with index close (Ship & Bunker) and Integr8 Friday 2 October indications.

Singapore Fell Again; Most Hubs Followed

Singapore VLSFO fell to US\$789.00 on Ship & Bunker's index, down US\$85 from the 874.00 we reported in Issue 009. MGO fell further, from US\$1,325 to US\$1,137, and IFO380 from US\$711.50 to US\$630. The 20-port VLSFO average is down to US\$855.50. Integr8's Singapore paper points the same way: its October 0.5% FOB swap is US\$782.94, down from US\$806.90 a week ago, and the curve falls to US\$682.20 by January.

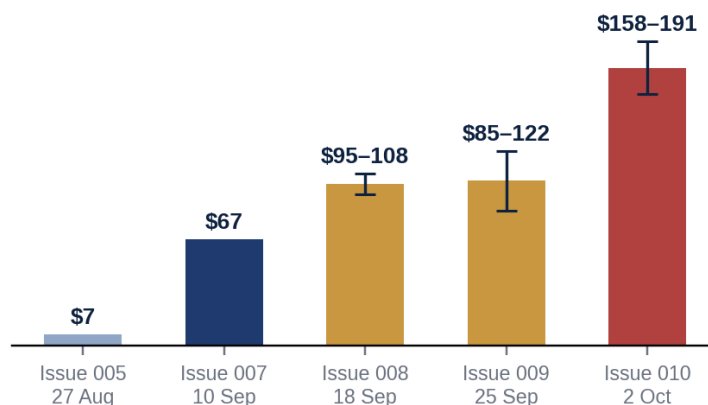
Fujairah is the exception, and the sources disagree about how far it is out of line (next page). Singapore's fall and the diesel crisis pull in opposite directions for MGO buyers: physical gasoil in Asia is under pressure from China's export halt, so the drop in Singapore MGO may not last.



The Fujairah Premium

Corroborated figures only — Ship & Bunker, Integr8 and Bunker Index

Fujairah VLSFO premium over Singapore, US\$/mt



Fujairah VLSFO premium over Singapore across the last five issues. Issues 008–010 shown as ranges; Issue 010 uses the two corroborated Fujairah figures (Integr8, Bunker Index) against Ship & Bunker Singapore.

The Fujairah Premium: Wider, on Any Reasonable Reading

Using the two Fujairah figures that agree — Integr8's US\$980 and Bunker Index's US\$947.50 — against Ship & Bunker's Singapore index of US\$789, the premium is **US\$158–191/mt**, up from US\$85–122 in Issue 009. Ship & Bunker's own Fujairah price would put it at about US\$452, and Integr8's own pair at US\$85; we do not rely on either because no second source supports them.

Last week the two sources disagreed on the direction of the premium. This week, every combination we can build from corroborated figures shows it wider. That is the more important finding.

What It Means for Buyers

For vessels trading between the Gulf and Asia, bunkering in Singapore or elsewhere in our corridor rather than in Fujairah now saves more than US\$150/mt on VLSFO on corroborated figures, subject to range and schedule. With Singapore MGO also lower, the saving extends to distillates. Ask for firm Fujairah quotes before assuming any published index applies; this week's spread between sources shows how thin and fast-moving that market is.

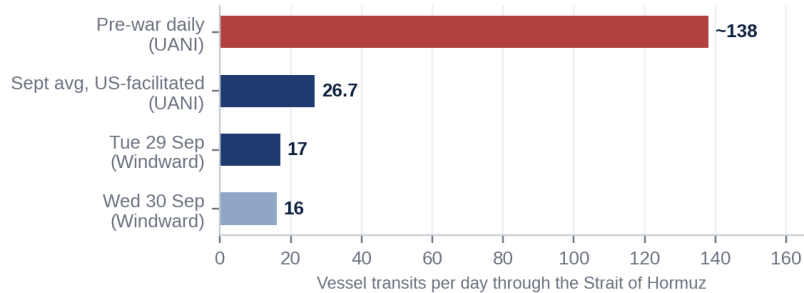
Compliance cost note: EU ETS exposure remains a separate line item on EU-linked voyages; state it explicitly in freight and bunker clauses.



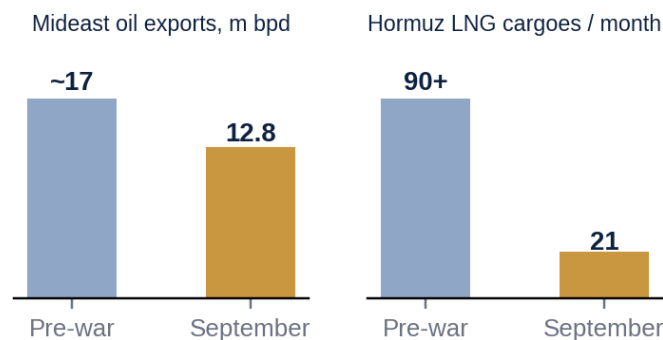
Geopolitical & Route Risk

Hormuz and the Red Sea — exports recovering under fire

Event	Detail	Commercial Consequence
Gulf exports recover	~12.8m bpd in September (Kpler); Hormuz flows ~77% of pre-war	More Gulf cargoes, but at continuing war risk
Hormuz tanker strikes	3 Liberia-flagged tankers hit 29–30 Sep; at least two dark	Darkened transits are not avoiding attack
US build-up	Third carrier group; 9,000–10,000 more troops; Patriots to Saudi and Qatar	Higher risk of renewed strikes on Iran
Talks	US rejected Iran's seven-day roadmap; indirect talks continue	No near-term reopening on agreed terms
Red Sea	Yanbu loading again; VLCCs still avoid southern Red Sea and Bab-el-Mandeb	Yanbu–Asia cargoes routed via Suez



Strait of Hormuz daily vessel transits. Sources: UANI (pre-war baseline and September US-facilitated average), Windward (29–30 September).



Gulf oil exports have recovered faster than LNG. Source: Kpler, as reported by Reuters via oilprice.com (28 September and 1 October).

DDS RISK LEVEL: CRITICAL (unchanged). Measures of recovery range from about 77% of pre-war Hormuz flows (Kpler) to 98% of pre-war Gulf exports (Marine Insight), depending on what is counted. On any measure, flows are rising faster than the threat is falling. Exports are recovering under fire, and the US build-up raises the risk of renewed strikes. Confirm war-risk terms at nomination, treat dark transits as no protection against attack, and keep realistic STS turnaround times of up to ten days on Saudi-origin cargo.



Sanctions & Compliance Watch

Actionable controls for fixtures and STS operations

Developments — Week Ending 2 October 2026

Iran's blacklist rises to 81 vessels. The Persian Gulf Strait Authority added four ships, including two Sinokor VLCCs and a Bahri VLCC, and warned that charterers who press owners to transit without its approval will have "all their vessels' transits restricted" (Seatrade, 28 September). OFAC has separately warned that complying with Iran's procedures may itself breach US sanctions.

US Treasury, 1 October. New sanctions target Iran's automotive, rail, metals and steel sectors. No vessels were designated in this action.

US blockade. UANI reports 125 commercial vessels redirected since 14 July, three disabled and two boarded. No crude-laden Iranian tanker has been tracked past the blockade since 12 July.

Charterer exposure: the PGSA warning is new. Charterers, not only owners, can now be listed. Combined with OFAC's position, this leaves charterers facing conflicting demands from Tehran and Washington on the same voyage.

Direct operational implication for DDS: UANI reports that Malaysian authorities carried out enforcement action at the eastern OPL anchorage in September, after which about 26 sanctions-linked tankers moved north. Around 18–19 such tankers remain at the EOPL, together with Iran-flagged ships. Screening in our own waters remains essential.

Control	Minimum Action
Iran blacklist screening	Check every nominated vessel and its STS counterparty against the current list (81 vessels)
Charterer exposure	Confirm whether the charterer or its other vessels appear on the PGSA list
US sanctions conflict	Do not follow Iranian transit procedures without sanctions advice
Malaysian waters	Heightened screening for STS near EOPL; check flag, ownership and AIS history
Record preservation	Keep screening evidence, approvals, emails, SOF and operational instructions in the job file

Editorial & Verification Note: DDS Marine Group publishes vessel names and designation detail only where attributable to a named primary source. Readers should verify any specific vessel against the current Iranian list, the OFAC SDN list and their own screening provider before acting.



Incident & Risk Watch

Confirmed and declared incidents, 26 September – 2 October 2026

Vessel / Target	Detail	Source	Date
Mersin Prosperity (VLCC)	Hit by unknown projectile in Hormuz; ADNOC L&S managed; Liberia flag	UKMTO / Marisks / Reuters	29–30 Sep
Al Ruwais (products tanker)	Hit by unknown projectile in Hormuz; ADNOC L&S managed; Liberia flag	UKMTO / Marisks / Reuters	29–30 Sep
Sinbad (Aframax)	Hit by unknown projectile in Hormuz; Anglo-Eastern managed; Liberia flag	UKMTO / Marisks / Reuters	29–30 Sep
Fire on board (one vessel)	Fire after projectile strike, extinguished; all crews safe	oilprice.com (Reuters)	29 Sep
Dark transits	6 of 16 Hormuz transits on 30 Sep were dark, all via the southern corridor	Windward	30 Sep

Pattern assessment: At least two of the three tankers struck this week were transiting with AIS off. Going dark has not prevented attack. UANI counts 89 maritime incidents and 24 seafarer deaths since the war began.

What We Are Watching

- Whether the arrival of additional US forces is followed by renewed strikes on Iran, and how Iran responds at sea.
- Whether attacks extend to the STS anchorages off Oman, where a large share of VLCC capacity is waiting.
- Whether the PGSA lists named charterers, and how P&I clubs respond.
- Whether Houthi attacks resume against Yanbu traffic now that loadings have restarted.

Ship Recycling & Demolition

GMS's weekly report (26 September, via Hellenic Shipping News) reported no fresh recycling sales, as strong tanker earnings keep older ships trading. Pakistan still leads, but without its August premium; Bangladesh is buying more steadily; India pays premiums for specialist and compliance-sensitive tonnage; and Turkey faces a weakening lira.



Southeast Asia & STS Operations

Malaysia · Singapore · Indonesia · Thailand · Vietnam — the Malacca-to-Penggerang corridor

Three developments matter for our corridor this week. First, Singapore bunkers fell while Fujairah stayed high, widening the saving for Gulf–Asia vessels that bunker here. Second, the diesel shortage is now global, and China’s export halt removes a major regional supplier, which supports clean-tanker demand in Asia. Third, Malaysian enforcement at the eastern OPL shows authorities are acting, and screening standards in our waters will be watched more closely.

Market	Why It Matters This Week
Malaysia	UANI reports enforcement action at the EOPL and movement of sanctions-linked tankers north; Iran-flagged ships remain at the EOPL and Port Klang. Screening discipline for Port Klang, Malacca, Muar, Linggi and Johor STS work is essential.
Singapore	VLSFO index US\$789 (range US\$770.50–825); MGO US\$1,137; IFO380 US\$630; all lower on the week.
Indonesia	Batam and Karimun remain active in STS and bunkering; expect enquiries from owners avoiding Fujairah.
Thailand	Gulf of Thailand distribution supported as China’s export halt tightens regional diesel.
Vietnam	Intra-Asia clean demand at our top score; a Vietnam-flagged LPG carrier was among normal-AIS Hormuz transits on 30 Sep (Windward).

STS & Marine-Services Operating Standard

Operational Pillar	DDS Standard
Planning	Job-specific JPO, risk assessment, mooring plan, weather limits, communications plan and emergency response.
Vessel suitability	Compatibility review covering freeboard, manifold, fenders, hoses, mooring arrangement, vetting and cargo system.
Counterparty & identity	IMO verification, beneficial ownership, full AIS dark-period review, cargo-origin documentary chain, Iranian blacklist and charterer check.
Cyber & systems	Confirm manual fallback for cargo, ballast and communications; brief crews on loss-of-control procedures.
Documentation	Accurate NOR, SOF, checklists, pumping records, delay evidence, photographs and final operation report.

DDS VIEW — *Enforcement at the EOPL is good news for compliant operators: it raises the cost of cutting corners. If disruption continues, DDS expects more tonnage and cargo interest in this corridor, and our standard must hold as volumes rise.*



DDS Freight Market Monitor

Independent DDS market sentiment — 1 = Weak | 2 = Soft | 3 = Balanced | 4 = Firm | 5 = Exceptionally Firm



DDS Freight Sentiment Index, 2 October 2026 — DDS Marine's own analytical assessment. Not a third-party benchmark.

Market	DDS Score	Trend	DDS Market Read
VLCC	5 / 5	— Steady	At the top; supported by Oman STS and the Yanbu restart.
Suezmax	5 / 5	▲ ▲	Sharpest gain this week; Atlantic demand.
Aframax	5 / 5	▲	Firmer across basins.
LR2	5 / 5	▲	Gulf-origin diesel and jet demand.
LR1	5 / 5	— Steady	Firm alongside LR2.
MR Pacific	5 / 5	▲	China's export halt adds to Asian diesel pull.
MR Atlantic	5 / 5	▲ ▲	Up from 4/5; Western diesel shortage.

DDS Gas & Regional Monitor

Market	DDS Tone	Trend	What DDS Is Watching
LPG	4 / 5 — Firm	— Steady	Holding firm across US Gulf and Middle East Gulf routes.
LNG	4 / 5 — Firm	— Mixed	Pacific rates firmer, Atlantic softer; JKM US\$25.71/MMBtu (Trading Economics, 2 Oct).
Intra-Asia CPP	5 / 5 — Exceptionally Firm	▲	China's export halt tightens the region.
Singapore-linked clean	5 / 5 — Exceptionally Firm	▲ Up from 4/5	Singapore-origin routes firmer; corridor demand rising.

DDS MARKET SIGNAL — Every tanker segment we track now scores 5/5, for the first time in this series. At this level the scale no longer separates the markets, so our focus shifts to which segment eases first. We expect VLCCs to be the first to ease if Hormuz traffic normalises, and product tankers to stay firm while the diesel shortage lasts.

Publication note: DDS scores are independent analytical opinions, not third-party benchmarks or executable freight quotations.
Editorial note: no fresh period or time-charter fixtures were available to DDS for this issue; one publicly reported voyage fixture appears on the Crude Tanker Market page.



Seven-Day Outlook: 3 – 9 October 2026

DDS base case with upside and downside risks

Market	Base Case	Upside Risk	Downside Risk
Crude oil	Brent US\$95–108; OPEC+ holds quotas on 4 Oct	Renewed US strikes on Iran: US\$110+	Hormuz flows near pre-war plus G7 barrels: below US\$95
VLCC / Suezmax	Top of the scale while the Oman shuttle and Yanbu run	Attack on the Oman STS anchorages	Normal Hormuz traffic releases shuttle tonnage
Product tankers	Firm while China's halt and Russia's ban last	Further refinery outages	G7 diesel arrives faster than expected
Bunkers	Singapore range-bound below US\$825; Fujairah premium above US\$150	Gasoil spike lifts MGO across Asia	Fujairah normalises as Gulf supply improves
Southeast Asia	Corridor demand rising; enforcement tighter	More Gulf buyers bunker and transfer here	A Hormuz settlement reduces diversion

Watch List

- The OPEC+ meeting on 4 October, and whether any Gulf producer seeks a quota change as exports recover.
- The arrival of additional US forces, and whether it is followed by renewed strikes on Iran.
- The pace of the G7 release, and whether China resumes fuel exports in November.
- Whether the first segment eases off the top of the DDS scale, and which one.
- Whether Ship & Bunker, Integr8 and Bunker Index converge on Fujairah, and whether Integr8's Singapore figures update.

DDS CONCLUSION — Gulf exports are back near their highest since the war began, and so is the risk of shipping them. Diesel has replaced crude as the market's tightest point, which keeps product tankers firm and bunker costs volatile. With every segment at the top of our scale, the useful signal from here is the first sign of easing. We plan on ranges, corroborated figures and the risk we can see.



Methodology, Sources & Disclaimer

ISSUE 010 — DATA CUT-OFF: FRIDAY 2 OCTOBER 2026

DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence combines public information, official releases, wire reporting carried by named outlets, and operator-focused analysis. Every price is shown with a stated cut-off and, where the source publishes one, a daily range. Where we hold more than one source for a benchmark, all are shown with the variance disclosed, and a figure is not relied on unless a second source supports it. DDS freight commentary is independent market analysis prepared from publicly available information, market-reported fixtures and operational intelligence. Proprietary third-party assessments are not reproduced unless authorised. DDS market sentiment indicators represent DDS Marine's own analytical assessment and are not third-party benchmarks.

Source	Information Used
Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), latest posted at 2 Oct cut-off	VLSFO/MGO/IFO380 High/Low/Index by hub; regional and global averages
Integr8 Fuels Daily Market Report, 2 Oct (DDS subscription)	Friday bunker indications by hub; Brent/WTI settles; forward paper
Bunker Index (bunkerindex.com), 2 Oct	Fujairah VLSFO, LSMGO and IFO380 (third-source check)
oilprice.com and Trading Economics, 28 Sep–2 Oct	Brent/WTI/Murban and Friday levels; Gulf exports; tanker strikes; China export halt; G7 release; Russia diesel ban; JKM
Flux; The National; NBC; Bloomberg	Brent intraday low on G7 news; G7 release detail
Seatrade Maritime; MarineLink; Marine Insight	Yanbu restart; DHT Gazelle fixture; blacklist (81); Indian refiner chartering
Al Jazeera; Axios; US Treasury	US military build-up; Patriot deployments; 1 October sanctions
Windward; UANI	Hormuz transits; dark vessels; tanker strikes; blockade statistics; Malaysian EOPL enforcement
GMS (via Hellenic Shipping News)	Ship recycling market review, 26 September
DDS Marine market intelligence	Broker quotes, open tonnage and cargo enquiries underpinning the DDS Freight Sentiment Index

What's changed since Issue 009 (25 September 2026): Middle East oil exports reached about 12.8m bpd in September and Yanbu loadings resumed, while three tankers were struck in Hormuz. The US is sending a third carrier group and more troops. China halted most October fuel exports and the G7 agreed a 100m-barrel reserve release. Brent eased to about US\$102.50. Singapore VLSFO fell to US\$789, and the Fujairah premium widened to US\$158–191/mt on corroborated figures. Every tanker segment DDS tracks now scores 5/5. Iran's blacklist stands at 81 vessels. Risk level remains CRITICAL.

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